

DANIEL OLSHANSKY

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ABOUT ME

Curious, relentless, and multidisciplinary engineer with 12+ years of experience and 3+ years of management across AR cloud infrastructure, autonomous vehicle evals, distributed systems, crypto protocols, and agentic micropayments. I do so by navigating tradeoffs, understanding human incentives, evaluating cognitive overload, biasing toward semi-automation, and thinking slowly while acting fast. I zoom in on details, zoom out on strategy, and build tools to automate everything in between.

EXPERIENCE

CTO @ Grove

2025 - Present

- **Context:** A pivot to agentic stablecoin based micropayments to enable content creator monetization.
- **Built:** A wallet-first landing page for creators. We saw the shift to stablecoin infrastructure, new protocols like x402, and shifted our strategy to enable humans and agents alike.
- **Impact:** Onboard hundreds of creators and processed thousands of micropayments for content across more than a dozen social networks.

Head of Protocol @ Pocket Network (CTO @ Grove Labs)

2021 - 2025

- **Context:** Managed a team designing & building a decentralized protocol, live on dozens of exchanges, managing alignment across hundreds of stakeholders.
- **Built:** Designed & led the R&D for a permissionless API marketplace serving decentralized data access at scale using a verifiable rate limiter.
- **Impact:** Launched a \$100M+ protocol serving 1B+ daily requests; led and rebuilt the core protocol team through a CTO transition.

Geotechnical Founder @ GetSoils & BreakingGround

2021–2022, 2025–Present

- **GetSoils (2021–2022):** Scaled an “AirBnB for construction soil” to hundreds of users in Ontario; learned that traditional industry adoption requires meeting customers where they are.
- **BreakingGround (2025–Present):** Fine-tuning visual models via the Tinker API for geotechnical soil analysis; educating the industry on pragmatic AI adoption at calgeo.org.

Senior Software Engineer, Planner Eval @ Waymo (Alphabet)

2020 - 2022

- **Context:** The Planner Eval team was responsible for evaluating planner models across real, simulated, golden, and adversarial datasets at scale.
- **Built:** Test set corpus for reproducible evals, labeling infrastructure, and visualization tools for data scientists on the Planner Eval team and beyond.
- **Impact:** Drove the org-wide test-set initiative; 50+ data scientists across 6+ teams managing thousands of test sets for mission-critical evals costing millions of dollars.

Lead Software Engineer, Augmented Reality Cloud @ Magic Leap

2016 - 2020

- **Context:** Joined day 1 of the cloud team at Magic Leap to build device management and design the AR cloud.
- **Built:** AR cloud digital twin using raw sensor data for object recognition, sparse/dense mapping, and multiplayer localization.
- **Impact:** Shipped Magic Leap One device management and the Shared World SDK to thousands of users. Led 5 engineers and co-authored 15+ patents.

Software Engineer @ Twitter

2014 - 2016

- **Context:** First engineering role out of college at a top-tier consumer platform; grew from coder to engineer.
- **Built:** A variety of full stack features across data pipelines, mobile, web, and backend on both the VIT and Media teams.
- **Impact:** Shipped GIF search, custom timelines, and vetted account features to 10s of millions of daily users.

EDUCATION

Internships

2011 - 2013

ModiFace (mobile computer vision), Twitter (iOS), Google (Android)

University of Toronto

2010 - 2014

B.A.Sc in Engineering Science, Electrical & Computer Engineering • GPA: 3.84 • Dean's List • NΨ 1T4

Thesis: Accelerating PCA for fMRI analysis using GPUs and MapReduce

ADDITIONAL RESOURCES *(all items below are hyperlinked)*

Writing: Posts, Thoughts, Substack, Medium

Consuming: Books, Podcasts, Movies, TV

Presenting: Talks & Interviews

Publishing: Google Scholar

TECHNICAL EXPERIENCE

Python · Go · Java · Scala · C/C++ · Elixir · iOS · Android · PostgreSQL · Kubernetes · GCP · MQTT · PubSub · MapReduce · Distributed Systems · Consensus Algorithms · API Design · Agentic Payments · Data Labeling · Test Sets · Tinker · x402 · Stablecoin · Agentic Infra & Tools · Skills